# ETHAMSYLATE

Capillary bleeding
Weak evidence base

**CHEMICAL NAME** Diethylammonium 2,5-dihydroxybenzenesulfonate (etamsylate)
**CLASS** Haemostatic agent (capillary stabiliser)
**TRADE NAMES** Dicynone · Dicynene · Hemsyl · Etamsylate

## THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Menorrhagia (heavy menstrual bleeding).
- Capillary bleeding: post-surgical (ENT, dental, urological), epistaxis.
- Prevention of periventricular haemorrhage in preterm infants (historical use).

## PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Increases capillary wall resistance and promotes platelet adhesion (via P-selectin).
- Does not affect coagulation factors or fibrinolysis; no vasoconstriction.

## ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** tablets with food or water.
- **IV/IM** injection slowly.
- Can be applied topically to bleeding gums or tooth sockets.

## SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

### SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Nausea, headache.
- Skin rash.
- Fever.

### ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Hypersensitivity reactions, angioedema.
- Transient hypotension (IV).
- Thromboembolism (rare).

## DOSAGES

- **PO (menorrhagia, capillary bleeding):** 500 mg three times daily (1.5 g/day) during bleeding.
- **Surgery:** 500 mg IV/IM 1 h before; 250 mg twice daily after. **Emergency:** 500–750 mg IV/IM three times daily.
- **Children:** same schedule at half the adult dose.

## CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Porphyria.
- Hypersensitivity (contains sulfite in some injections; asthma).
- **Caution:** history of thrombosis.

### KEY INTERACTIONS

- No significant interactions; may be combined with tranexamic acid.

## PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** IV 5–15 min; PO 1 h. **Duration:** 4–6 h.
- Not significantly metabolised.
- Excreted unchanged in urine. **t½:** 2 h.

## NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess blood loss (pad count, drains, Hb).
- Give IV slowly; monitor BP.
- Watch for allergy, especially in asthmatics.
- Investigate cause of persistent bleeding.

## PATIENT EDUCATION

- Menorrhagia: start at the beginning of the period; report if bleeding remains heavy.
- Report rash or swelling.

## KEY POINTS

- Capillary stabiliser; ↑ platelet adhesion.
- Used for menorrhagia and capillary oozing.
- No effect on clotting factors.
- Avoid in porphyria.

**SOURCES CHECKED** **[440]** Dicynone injection SmPC (ANSM, France) **[441]** Dicynone tablets SmPC (ANSM, France)
*Full references p. 432–457*